JAMES RICHARDSON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff Engineer with seven years of experience building and scaling backend systems at high-growth tech companies. I've spent the last three years leading technical strategy for a fintech platform, focusing on system reliability and helping other engineers ship better code. I care deeply about mentoring junior team members and writing clear documentation that actually gets read. Outside of work, I'm interested in distributed systems and spend weekends tinkering with Rust.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

Vertex Finance

www.vertexfinance.io

London, United Kingdom

June 2022 - Present

Designed and implemented a microservices migration strategy that reduced API response times by 40% and improved deployment frequency from weekly to daily releases for a team of eight engineers. Led the adoption of Kubernetes across our infrastructure, resulting in 30% cost reduction and better resource utilization. Established code review standards and mentored four junior engineers through their first major production incidents, improving incident response times by 25%. Built an observability framework using Prometheus and Grafana that reduced mean time to detection for critical issues from 15 minutes to 2 minutes.

Senior Backend Engineer

CloudBridge Systems

www.cloudbridgesystems.co

Cambridge, United Kingdom

March 2020 - May 2022

Architected a real-time event streaming pipeline handling 2 million events per second using Kafka and Apache Flink, enabling the product team to launch personalization features. Reduced database query latency by 35% through query optimization and implementation of a distributed caching layer using Redis. Owned the incident response process for a team of six engineers, establishing runbooks and conducting post-mortems that reduced repeat incidents by 60%. Implemented comprehensive integration tests that improved code coverage from 45% to 78% and caught 15 production bugs before release.

Backend Engineer

DataLoop Technologies

www.dataloop.net

Bristol, United Kingdom

September 2017 - February 2020

Developed and maintained REST APIs serving 50 million daily requests, ensuring 99.95% uptime while handling traffic spikes during peak usage periods. Implemented database sharding strategy that allowed the platform to scale from 10GB to 500GB of data without performance degradation. Collaborated with DevOps to establish CI/CD

pipelines using Jenkins and Docker, reducing deployment time from 45 minutes to 8 minutes. Debugged and resolved critical production issues affecting payment processing, preventing estimated losses of £100,000 in revenue.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Cambridge

Cambridge, United Kingdom

Graduated June 2017

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, Java, SQL, Bash

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch

Cloud and Infrastructure: AWS, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform

Messaging and Streaming: Kafka, RabbitMQ, Apache Flink

Monitoring and Logging: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, DataDog

Tools and Practices: Git, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Agile methodologies, TDD